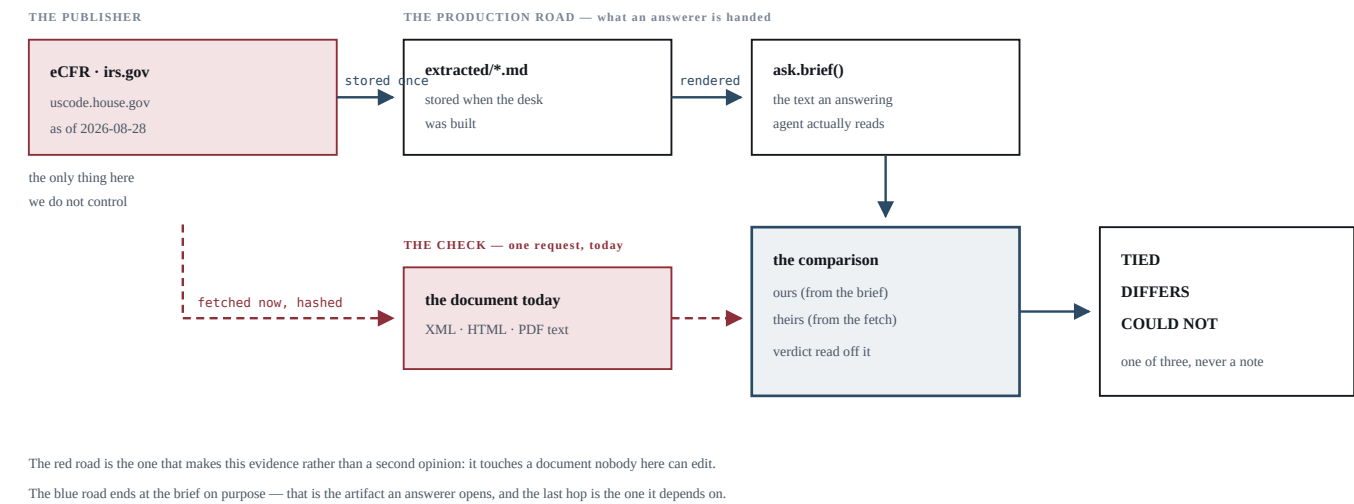


fixed-assets

Every passage this desk hands to an answering agent, put back to the publisher that wrote it. **The question is not whether our tests pass.** It is whether the authority we serve is what the authority actually says — which no test in this repository can answer, because they all read the same stored files.



The same passage, two roads. They meet at the comparison, and the verdict is read off that block rather than written ahead of it.

The roster

0	0	289 of 289	1
DIFFERS	COULD NOT	TIED	SOURCES FETCHED LIVE

Of the **289** that tied, **289** matched the publisher's characters exactly, **0** matched only once whitespace was ignored, and **0** carry a marked omission and were checked segment by segment, in order. All three are declared, and explained under what this does not prove.

289 + 0 + 0 = 289, which is the tied count above. THE SENTENCE USED TO NAME TWO OF THE THREE and so did not add up — 43 and 4 against 49 tied on the cash desk, with the two marked omissions unaccounted for. A breakdown that does not sum to its own total is the failure this exhibit exists to catch, printed by the exhibit.

The sample of one, worked end to end

The longest passage on this desk, because a long one has the most places to be wrong.

1 · THE FIGURE — AND WHERE A READER SEES IT

Not a row of a database: the paragraph of authority the desk hands an answering agent under the citation 26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(3) Example 8. It is read out of ask.brief(), which is the text that agent opens, and it is 4,420 characters long.

(i) G owns a large chain of retail stores that sell a variety of items. G determines that due to changes in the retail market, it can no longer compete in its current store class and decides to upgrade its stores to offer higher end products to a different type of customer. To offer these products and attract different types of customers, G must substantially remodel its stores. Thus, G pays amounts to remodel its stores by performing work on the buildings' structures and systems as defined under paragraphs (e)(2)(ii)(A) and (e)(2)(ii)(B) of this section. This work includes replacing large parts of the exterior walls with windows, replacing the escalators with a monumental staircase, adding a new glass enclosed elevator, rebuilding the interior and exterior facades, replacing vinyl floors with ceramic flooring, replacing ceiling tiles with acoustical tiles, and removing and rebuilding walls to move changing rooms and create specialty departments. The work also includes upgrades to increase the capacity of the buildings' electrical system to accommodate the structural changes and the addition of new section 1245 property, such as new product information kiosks and point of sale systems. The work to the electrical system also involves the installation of new more efficient and mood enhancing lighting fixtures. In addition, the work includes remodeling all bathrooms by replacing contractor-grade plumbing fixtures with designer-grade fixtures that conserve water and energy. Finally, G also pays amounts to clean debris resulting from construction during the remodel, patch holes in walls that were made to upgrade the electrical system, repaint existing walls with a new color scheme to match the new interior construction, and to power wash building exteriors to enhance the new exterior facade.

(ii) Under paragraphs (e)(2)(ii) and (j)(2)(ii) of this section, an amount is paid to improve a building unit of property if the amount is paid for a betterment to the building structure or any building system. Considering the facts and circumstances, including the purpose of the expenditure, the physical nature of the work performed, and the effect of the work on the buildings' structures and buildings' systems, the amounts that G pays for the remodeling of its stores result in betterments to the buildings' structures and several of its systems under paragraph (j) of this section. Specifically, the amounts paid to replace large parts of the exterior walls with windows, replace the escalators with a monumental staircase, add a new elevator, rebuild the interior and exterior facades, replace vinyl floors with ceramic flooring, replace the ceiling tiles with acoustical tiles, and to remove and rebuild walls are for material additions, that is the addition of major components, to the building structure under paragraph (j)(1)(ii) of this section and are reasonably expected to increase the quality of the building structure under paragraph (j)(1)(iii) of this section. Similarly, the amounts paid to upgrade the electrical system are to materially increase the capacity of the electrical system under paragraph (j)(1)(ii) of this section and are reasonably expected to increase the quality of this system under paragraph (j)(1)(iii) of this section. In addition, the amounts paid to remodel the bathrooms with higher grade and more resource-efficient materials are reasonably expected to increase the efficiency and quality of the plumbing system under paragraph (j)(1)(iii) of this section. Finally, the amounts paid to clean debris, patch and repaint existing walls with a new color scheme, and to power wash building exteriors, while not betterments by themselves, directly benefitted and were incurred by reason of the improvements to G's store buildings' structures and electrical systems under paragraph (g)(1) of this section. Therefore, G must treat the amounts paid for betterments to the store buildings' structures and systems, including the costs of cleaning, patching, repairing, and power washing the building, as improvements to G's buildings and must capitalize these amounts under paragraphs (d)(1) and (j) of this section. Moreover, G is required to capitalize the amounts paid to acquire and install each section 1245 property in accordance with § 1.263(a)-2(d)(1). For the treatment of amounts paid to remove components of property, see paragraph (g)(2) of this section.

2 · THE CALL — COPY-PASTABLE, WITH THE REAL VALUES IN IT

```
curl -sS --compressed "https://www.ecfr.gov/api/versioner/v1/full/2026-08-28/title-26.xml?section=1.263(a)-3"
```

Fetches 2026-09-07 02:59:40Z · 245,744 bytes · SHA-256

54a44c43b83e1beba44061bfbf50ca1a2395e6ce67b1193ce6a4483296dba28a

3 · THE DERIVATION — WHAT HAPPENS BETWEEN THE TWO

The response is turned into plain text: an XML or HTML document has its inline tags closed up and its block tags turned into a space, a PDF is read page by page. Both sides are then folded the same way — Unicode normalised, and the typographic quotes and dashes

publishers vary between renderings mapped to their plain forms. **Nothing else is changed.**

The stored text either occurs in the publisher's document or it does not.

4 · THE INDEPENDENT SOURCE — CAPTURED, NOT SUMMARISED

The publisher's own words around the match, quoted verbatim out of the bytes whose hash is printed above. **A reader re-fetches that URL, recomputes the hash, and gets the same digits** — which is a check a photograph cannot offer.

...operty in accordance with § 1.263(a)-2(d)(1). Example 8. Betterment; building remodel (i) G owns a large chain of retail stores that sell a variety of items. G determines that due to changes in the retail market, it can no longer compete in its current store class and decides to upgrade its stores to offer higher end products to a different type of customer. To offer these products and attract different types of customers, G must substantially remodel its stores. Thus, G pays amounts to remodel its stores by performing work on the buildings' structures and systems as defined under paragraphs (e)(2)(ii)(A) and (e)(2)(ii)(B) of this section. This work includes replacing large parts of the exterior walls with windows, replacing the escalators with a monumental staircase, adding a new glass enclosed elevator, rebuilding the interior and exterior facades, replacing vinyl floors with ceramic flooring, replacing ceiling tiles with acoustical tiles, and removing and rebuilding walls to move changing rooms and create specialty departments. The work also includes upgrades to increase the capacity of the buildings' electrical system to accommodate the structural changes and the addition of new section 1245 property, such as new product information kiosks and point of sale systems. The work to the electrical system also involves the installation of new more efficient and mood enhancing lighting fixtures. In addition, the work includes remodeling all bathrooms by replacing contractor-grade plumbing fixtures with designer-grade fixtures that conserve water and energy. Finally, G also pays amounts to clean debris resulting from construction during the remodel, patch holes in walls that were made to upgrade the electrical system, repaint existing walls with a new color scheme to match the new interior construction, and to power wash building exteriors to enhance the new exterior facade. (ii) Under paragraphs (e)(2)(ii) and (j)(2)(ii) of this section, an amount is paid to improve a building unit of property if the amount is paid for a betterment to the building structure or any building system. Considering the facts and circumstances, including the purpose of the expenditure, the physical nature of the work performed, and the effect of the work on the buildings' structures and buildings' systems, the amounts that G pays for the remodeling of its stores result in betterments to the buildings' structures and several of its systems under paragraph (j) of this section. Specifically, the amounts paid to replace large parts of the exterior walls with windows, replace the escalators with a monumental staircase, add a new elevator, rebuild the interior and exterior facades, replace vinyl floors with ceramic flooring, replace the ceiling tiles with acoustical tiles, and to remove and rebuild walls are for material additions, that is the addition of major components, to the building structure under paragraph (j)(1)(ii) of this section and are reasonably expected to increase the quality of the building structure under paragraph (j)(1)(iii) of this section. Similarly, the amounts paid to upgrade the electrical system are to materially increase the capacity of the electrical system under paragraph (j)(1)(ii) of this section and are reasonably expected to increase the quality of this system under paragraph (j)(1)(iii) of this section. In addition, the amounts paid to remodel the bathrooms with higher grade and more resource-efficient materials are reasonably expected to increase the efficiency and quality of the plumbing system under paragraph (j)(1)(iii) of this section. Finally, the amounts paid to clean debris, patch and repaint existing walls with a new color scheme, and to power wash building exteriors, while not betterments by themselves, directly benefitted and were incurred by reason of the improvements to G's store buildings' structures and electrical systems under paragraph (g)(1) of this section. Therefore, G must treat the amounts paid for betterments to the store buildings' structures and systems, including the costs of cleaning, patching, repairing, and power washing the building, as improvements to G's buildings and must capitalize these amounts under paragraphs (d)(1) and (j) of this section. Moreover, G is required to capitalize the amounts paid to acquire and install each section 1245 property in accordance with § 1.263(a)-2(d)(1). For the treatment of amounts paid to remove components of property, see paragraph (g)(2) of this section. Example 9. Not betterment; relocation and reinstallation of personal property In Year 1, H purchases new cash registers for use in its retail store located in leased space in a shopping mall. Assume that each cash register is a unit of property as determined ...

5 · THE COMPARISON

ours	(ask.brief → 26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(3) Example 8) 4,420 characters
theirs	(https://www.ecfr.gov/api/versioner/v1/full/2026-08-28/ti) 4,420 of them found, verbatim, in the document fetched above
diff	none

TIED — the publisher’s characters exactly

Every passage on this desk

VERDICT	CITATION	CHARS	HOW / WHY
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(a)	1,902	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(b)	75	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(b)(1)	310	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(b)(2)	77	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(b)(3)	511	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(b)(4)	128	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(c)	46	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(c)(1)	398	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(c)(2)	226	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(c)(3)	75	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(c)(3) Example 1	305	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(d)	935	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(d)(1)	81	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(d)(2)	68	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(d)(3)	89	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)	32	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(1)	1,220	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(2)	8	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(2)(i)	533	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(2)(ii)	249	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(2)(ii)(A)	272	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(2)(ii)(B)	254	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(2)(ii)(B)(1)	145	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(2)(ii)(B)(2)	270	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(2)(ii)(B)(3)	246	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(2)(ii)(B)(4)	15	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(2)(ii)(B)(5)	14	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(2)(ii)(B)(6)	362	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(2)(ii)(B)(7)	276	exact

VERDICT	CITATION	CHARS	HOW / WHY
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(2)(ii)(B)(8)	170	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(2)(ii)(B)(9)	329	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(2)(iii)	11	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(2)(iii)(A)	306	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(2)(iii)(B)	706	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(2)(iv)	11	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(2)(iv)(A)	383	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(2)(iv)(B)	787	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(2)(v)	15	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(2)(v)(A)	359	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(2)(v)(B)	276	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(2)(v)(B)(1)	283	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(2)(v)(B)(2)	384	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(3)	28	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(3)(i)	499	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(3)(ii)	14	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(3)(ii)(A)	338	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(3)(ii)(B)	372	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(3)(iii)	14	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(3)(iii)(A)	674	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(3)(iii)(B)	442	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(3)(iv)	454	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(4)	649	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(5)	16	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(5)(i)	688	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(5)(ii)	1,027	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(6)	381	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(6) Example 1	1,127	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(6) Example 10	1,172	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(6) Example 11	755	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(6) Example 12	423	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(6) Example 13	1,781	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(6) Example 14	429	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(6) Example 15	1,603	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(6) Example 16	1,406	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(6) Example 17	924	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(6) Example 18	773	exact

VERDICT	CITATION	CHARS	HOW / WHY
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(6) Example 19	1,139	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(6) Example 2	935	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(6) Example 3	1,375	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(6) Example 4	1,394	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(6) Example 5	1,665	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(6) Example 6	1,560	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(6) Example 7	1,052	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(6) Example 8	612	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(e)(6) Example 9	694	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(f)	31	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(f)(1)	880	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(f)(2)	19	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(f)(2)(i)	1,054	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(f)(2)(ii)	736	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(f)(3)	19	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(f)(3)(i)	1,253	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(f)(3)(ii)	524	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(f)(4)	359	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(f)(4) Example 1	3,783	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(f)(4) Example 2	2,513	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(f)(4) Example 3	1,628	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(f)(4) Example 4	763	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(f)(4) Example 5	1,405	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(f)(4) Example 6	1,065	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(g)	47	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(g)(1)	44	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(g)(1)(i)	492	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(g)(1)(ii)	386	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(g)(2)	13	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(g)(2)(i)	1,272	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(g)(2)(ii)	408	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(g)(2)(ii) Example 1	961	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(g)(2)(ii) Example 2	732	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(g)(2)(ii) Example 3	1,255	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(g)(2)(ii) Example 4	981	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(g)(3)	298	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(g)(4)	319	exact

VERDICT	CITATION	CHARS	HOW / WHY
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(h)	31	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(h)(1)	421	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(h)(1)(i)	123	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(h)(1)(ii)	8	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(h)(10)	134	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(h)(10) Example 1	1,312	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(h)(10) Example 2	772	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(h)(10) Example 3	2,264	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(h)(10) Example 4	1,478	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(h)(2)	446	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(h)(3)	19	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(h)(3)(i)	247	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(h)(3)(ii)	284	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(h)(3)(iii)	154	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(h)(3)(iii)(A)	62	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(h)(3)(iii)(B)	120	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(h)(3)(iv)	2,047	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(h)(4)	398	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(h)(5)	16	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(h)(5)(i)	693	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(h)(5)(ii)	636	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(h)(6)	1,489	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(h)(7)	574	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(h)(8)	788	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(h)(9)	281	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)	47	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)(1)	377	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)(1)(i)	1,853	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)(1)(ii)	1,707	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)(2)	278	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)(3)	63	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)(3)(i)	88	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)(3)(ii)	228	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)(3)(iii)	283	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)(3)(iv)	341	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)(3)(v)	240	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)(3)(vi)	103	exact

VERDICT	CITATION	CHARS	HOW / WHY
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)(3)(vii)	132	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)(3)(viii)	212	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)(4)	602	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)(5)	472	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)(6)	375	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)(6) Example 1	2,613	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)(6) Example 10	1,833	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)(6) Example 11	1,229	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)(6) Example 12	1,770	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)(6) Example 13	1,651	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)(6) Example 14	865	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)(6) Example 15	1,988	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)(6) Example 2	626	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)(6) Example 3	1,807	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)(6) Example 4	1,665	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)(6) Example 5	1,156	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)(6) Example 6	2,197	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)(6) Example 7	1,092	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)(6) Example 8	1,827	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(i)(6) Example 9	1,994	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)	29	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(1)	180	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(1)(i)	285	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(1)(ii)	301	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(1)(iii)	129	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(2)	31	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(2)(i)	477	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(2)(ii)	595	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(2)(iii)	364	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(2)(iv)	22	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(2)(iv)(A)	463	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(2)(iv)(B)	615	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(2)(iv)(C)	312	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(3)	400	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(3) Example 1	624	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(3) Example 10	1,138	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(3) Example 11	1,604	exact

VERDICT	CITATION	CHARS	HOW / WHY
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(3) Example 12	1,820	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(3) Example 13	1,941	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(3) Example 14	968	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(3) Example 15	715	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(3) Example 16	1,190	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(3) Example 17	951	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(3) Example 18	1,203	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(3) Example 19	956	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(3) Example 2	1,931	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(3) Example 20	2,147	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(3) Example 21	1,124	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(3) Example 22	1,405	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(3) Example 23	1,455	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(3) Example 3	2,198	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(3) Example 4	1,771	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(3) Example 5	2,308	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(3) Example 6	2,861	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(3) Example 7	2,257	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(3) Example 8	4,420	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(j)(3) Example 9	843	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)	30	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(1)	249	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(1)(i)	175	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(1)(ii)	230	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(1)(iii)	287	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(1)(iv)	183	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(1)(v)	209	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(1)(vi)	197	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(2)	696	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(3)	333	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(4)	35	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(4)(i)	220	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(4)(i)(A)	189	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(4)(i)(B)	209	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(4)(ii)	531	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(5)	453	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(6)	65	exact

VERDICT	CITATION	CHARS	HOW / WHY
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(6)(i)	454	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(6)(i)(A)	378	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(6)(i)(B)	174	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(6)(ii)	214	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(6)(ii)(A)	437	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(6)(ii)(B)	347	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7)	480	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7) Example 1	940	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7) Example 10	1,123	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7) Example 11	1,574	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7) Example 12	2,986	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7) Example 13	1,225	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7) Example 14	1,353	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7) Example 15	1,664	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7) Example 16	1,348	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7) Example 17	1,388	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7) Example 18	1,851	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7) Example 19	1,102	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7) Example 2	460	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7) Example 20	1,162	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7) Example 21	1,253	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7) Example 22	1,480	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7) Example 23	848	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7) Example 24	2,894	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7) Example 25	1,511	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7) Example 26	893	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7) Example 27	1,169	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7) Example 28	1,551	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7) Example 29	1,367	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7) Example 3	992	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7) Example 30	1,713	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7) Example 31	1,032	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7) Example 4	823	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7) Example 5	1,954	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7) Example 6	1,279	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7) Example 7	1,726	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7) Example 8	372	exact

VERDICT	CITATION	CHARS	HOW / WHY
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(k)(7) Example 9	2,889	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(l)	69	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(l)(1)	361	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(l)(2)	550	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(l)(3)	429	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(l)(3) Example 1	1,247	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(l)(3) Example 2	1,151	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(l)(3) Example 3	789	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(l)(3) Example 4	1,386	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(l)(3) Example 5	2,162	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(l)(3) Example 6	2,005	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(l)(3) Example 7	1,637	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(m)	37	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(m)(1)	961	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(m)(2)	495	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(m)(3)	1,165	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(m)(4)	82	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(m)(4) Example 1	662	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(m)(4) Example 2	307	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(m)(4) Example 3	538	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(m)(4) Example 4	400	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(n)	51	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(n)(1)	879	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(n)(2)	1,965	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(n)(3)	245	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(n)(4)	82	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(n)(4) Example 1	1,600	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(n)(4) Example 2	805	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(n)(4) Example 3	1,168	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(o)	301	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(p)	398	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(q)	538	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(r)	28	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(r)(1)	475	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(r)(2)	33	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(r)(2)(i)	316	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(r)(2)(ii)	1,103	exact

VERDICT	CITATION	CHARS	HOW / WHY
TIED	26 CFR 1.263(a)-3(r)(3)	218	exact

The sources, and that they can disagree with us

- **S1** — Treasury Regulation § 1.263(a)-3 — Amounts paid to improve tangible property
[https://www.ecfr.gov/api/versioner/v1/full/2026-08-28/title-26.xml?section=1.263\(a\)-3](https://www.ecfr.gov/api/versioner/v1/full/2026-08-28/title-26.xml?section=1.263(a)-3)

Not one of these is ours. None is a cache, a fixture or a second copy of our own record — which is the test the tie-out skill puts first: **could this disagree with me?** Each one can, and two of them did.

How to run this yourself

Every step below has the real values already in it. Nothing here needs me.

1 · RE-RUN THE WHOLE CHECK

```
cd desk && python -B tools/tieout.py
```

It fetches every source live and writes tie-outs/findings.json. Expect it to take a few minutes: it pauses between requests rather than hammering the publishers.

2 · REBUILD THESE DOCUMENTS FROM THAT RUN

```
cd desk && python -B tools/tieout_exhibit.py
```

3 · CHECK ONE LINE BY HAND, WITHOUT EITHER SCRIPT

Take any row in the roster, fetch its URL, and look for the text yourself:

```
curl -sS --compressed "https://www.ecfr.gov/api/versioner/v1/full/2026-08-28/title-26.xml?section=1.263(a)-3" | shasum -a 256
```

If that hash matches the one printed with the exemplar above, you are reading the same bytes this document read. Then search the document for the passage — the desk prints it under that citation in the brief:

```
cd desk && python -B -c "import sys; sys.path.insert(0, '.'); import ask, record, pathlib; \
print(ask.brief('show me', record.load(pathlib.Path('desks/fixed-assets'))))" | less
```

What it found

Nothing, and that sentence had to be earned three times over. All 531 passages the seven desks hand an answering agent are, today, what the publisher publishes: **0 differs, 0 could not.** The run this morning said 533 and two; the one before it said 88 differences. What changed in between is the record and the checker, and both are worth reading before this figure is believed.

The three findings this run closed, each fixed in the record rather than in the check.

- **Right text, wrong link — three passages.** The rewards desk stored § 6041, § 6041A, § 6050W and § 6071 under ONE source whose recorded URL is the House's granule for **§ 6041 only**. All four bodies were **verbatim correct**, so nothing served was ever wrong and no test in the repository could have seen it — a reader following the citation for three of the four simply landed on a page that did not contain it. **Only opening the link finds this.** Split into four sources, four URLs, each verified live; and the record now has a test comparing the URL a citation is really on with the URL its source claims.
- **A partial quotation that did not say it was one.** Publication 583's sentence has two branches and the cash desk stored the second without marking the omission. The split is right — the branches have opposite answers, which is the defect #264 found — but an answerer could not tell a branch had been removed. Marked now with [. . .], and the mark is CHECKED rather than excused: every segment must appear in the live document, in order.
- **A publisher's interface text inside a quotation.** irs.gov appends the word **PDF** to links that point at PDFs, and one sits mid-sentence on the tangible-property page. Ours dropped it. This was judged in our favour this morning and left; it is the same unmarked omission as Pub 583, and it is marked now. It was the last difference in the corpus.

What "nothing" is worth here. Three of the 531 tied only because a marked omission was checked segment by segment, and 13 tied only once whitespace was ignored. Both are declared, both are counted on each desk's own sheet, and neither is silently folded into the headline. A clean run that hides how it got clean is the thing this exhibit exists not to be.

What I got wrong

The first run reported 88 differences and 34 of them were mine. The extractor replaced every markup tag with a space, so eCFR's `</I>(1)` came back as `election - (1)` and `601.601(d)(2)(ii)<I>b</I>` as `( b )`. A checker that invents differences is worse than no checker, because somebody goes and "fixes" the record to match it. Inline tags now close up and only block tags become a space.

Then it reported 18, and 16 of those were mine too. pypdf reads a kerned two-column IRS page as `Y ou` and hyphenates `infor-mation` across a line break, and irs.gov puts block markup inside a sentence. Those are rendering artefacts of the extractor, not differences in what was published — so the comparison now runs twice, and the exhibit says which pass carried each line rather than quietly folding them together.

I could not capture the sources as photographs, and the skill asks for photographs.

This machine's browser cannot reach the publishers even when pointed at the egress proxy — `ERR_CONNECTION_RESET` — while the HTTP client reaches them fine. Attempted, failed, recorded. What is here instead is the document itself: its SHA-256, its length, the moment it was fetched and the publisher's own words quoted around each match. For text that is the stronger evidence, because a reader can recompute the hash and a screenshot cannot be re-verified at all.

What this does not prove

- **It proves the words, not the reading.** That § 1.263(a)-1(f)(1)(ii)(D) says \$500 is now established. Whether \$500 is the number that governs a client is a question about Notice 2015-82 and about the firm's election, and no fetch settles it.
- **It proves containment, not completeness.** The check asks whether our passage occurs in the publisher's document. It does not ask whether we stored the *whole* of what that citation covers — a passage could be a true fragment of a paragraph whose second half changes its meaning. Publication 583 above is exactly that failure caught by accident, not by design.
- **The whitespace-ignoring pass can hide a genuinely missing space.** 13 lines tied only on that pass. Each is named in the roster as spacing so nobody has to take it on trust.
- **The regulations were fetched as of 2026-08-28, not today.** eCFR's versioner refuses a future date and this is the last date known good on it. A regulation amended between that date and now would not show here.
- **One reading, not two.** The skill asks for a second rendering where one exists — the XML and the rendered page, the PDF and the HTML. Only one rendering per source was read. A digit or a word wrong in *both* our copy and the one rendering we read would pass.
- **Nothing here touches whether a desk answers well.** This is about the authority it is given. A desk with a perfect corpus can still reason badly from it, and that is what the scoreboard is for.